In short, scanning the world since the major financial and climate policy shifts were taken in 2008–2009, it is evident that BRICS from above repeatedly enable the West's most self-destructive habits during times of acute crisis:

- the April 2009 G20 bailout of Western banks via consensus on a $750 billion IMF global liquidity infusion;
- the December 2009 Copenhagen Accord in which four of the five BRICS did a deal to continue emitting unabated (they 'blew up the UN', according to Bill McKibben of 350.org);
- the 2011-12 acquiescence to the (s)election of new European and US chief executives for the Bretton Woods institutions (for despite a little whingeing, the BRICS couldn't even decide on joint candidates); and
- the 2012 agreement to pay over another $75 billion to the IMF even though it was apparent Washington wasn't going to change its undemocratic ways (the US Congress has refused to allocate the BRICS a higher IMF voting share).

Washington's co-dependants in Delhi and Pretoria are the most blindly loyal. Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) reactionaries and African National Congress (ANC) neoliberals have regular economic, political and even military dalliances with Washington (United States Department of State 2013), and the BJP is so irretrievably backward that it won't countenance even a parliamentary debate about Israel's Gaza terrorism (*Economic Times* 2014). Playing the role of a frosty, distant relative, the other BRICS elites in Moscow, Brasilia and Beijing occasionally fulminate against Washington's internet snooping and, to Putin's credit, thank goodness the US whistle-blower spy Edward Snowden is at least safe in Russia. But it's likely that BRICS promises to establish new internet connectivity safe from US National Security Agency data-thieves will be broken, and as China's constant internet surveillance and censorship show, conjoined with 2015 revelations about Spy Cables linking Pretoria's spy agency to Israel's Mossad, the BRICS are as bad as, if not worse than, Washington, in terms of maintaining the most vital public good society has yet created: the internet. Another Fortaleza political let-down: the refusal by both Moscow and Beijing to support the other three BRICS' ascension to the UN Security Council in spite of their repeated requests for UN democratisation, because that would lead to dilution of Russian and Chinese power.

The greatest heartbreak, however, will be the passing of sub-imperialism's financial costs to BRICS citizenries and hinterlands. Before the Fortaleza summit, economic justice activists hoped the BRICS would decisively weaken